



Jubilation: Jemimah Rodrigues takes her customary winning selfie with the team. India has now won four of its last five women's Tests, while England has lost four of its last five. REUTERS

new-ball partner, Sayali Satghare, also bowled well as they removed both England openers inside the first three overs.

Kranti had accounted for Tammy Beaumont, who fell for a golden duck in her final Test innings. Beaumont had announced her retirement from international cricket a couple of days earlier and broke down during the ensuing press

conference, but recovered quickly enough to crack jokes.

Then, midway through the match, Heather Knight also announced that she would not play for England again. She had led England to the ODI World Cup title in 2017 at the same venue. Lord's is her favourite ground. She could at least take solace in returning to Lord's as general manager of the London

Spirit franchise.

England may not find it easy to replace Beaumont and Knight, who, between them, scored more than 15,000 runs for England. Their careers also spanned the game's remarkable transformation, allowing them to witness and benefit from its growing stature.

The MCC, which had resisted women's membership for so long, threw its weight behind promoting the women's Test. There was an attractive campaign centred around Knight.

"The first Women's Test at Lord's was a major priority for MCC, and we invested significantly in marketing the occasion to attract a broad and diverse audience while celebrating this historic moment for the game," MCC's Chief Marketing Officer Katie Maier told *Sportstar*. "The response has been phenomenal, exceeding sales expectations since launch and helping to deliver a new world-record attendance for a women's Test match. Heather's retirement at the conclusion of the Test has added even greater poignancy to the occasion, marking such a special and significant moment in her remarkable career."

Knight, however, could not produce the rescue act she had performed for England on so many



Lynchpin: Sneha Rana picked up four wickets in the second innings and fittingly the last one too. REUTERS